hill is also a landscape taking a new sacral shape, a reconfiguration with consequences for posterity, a change in the historical trajectory of a region.

Were these caves benefaction intended only for the Ajivikas? Two of them, the Sudama and Vishwa Jhopri caves, certainly were. The Karna Chaupar cave, created as a shelter against rain, specifies no sect as recipient and could have been for the Ajivikas or other mendicants. More challenging is the Lomasha Rishi cave. The architrave on its exterior has strong Buddhist overtones, so it may have been a dwelling for the desirably faithful. If so, it would suggest an Ashokan way of promoting harmony among religious cults, the sort proclaimed in his edicts. Inter-faith coexistence and rivalry were integral to this period of strife and competition for sectarian adherents, and relations between Ajivikas and Buddhists were, for instance, depicted in a variety of ways. In the Buddhist literature some Ajivikas are cruel and deceitful, others are shown in the company of Buddhists and, on occasion, fed by them.[10] The Jainas were thought to have had an early and close relationship with the Ajivikas, but there were tensions when several Ajivikas converted to Jainism.